

Frequently asked questions

How do memory cards differ from other portable storage media?

Compared to other portable storage media, flash memory cards are safe, secure, portable, convenient and affordable. In fact, the primary difference is the size of memory cards in comparison to USB flash drives and portable hard drives with the same capacity. This is mainly because of differences in functionality and accessibility. Memory cards, unlike USB flash drives and portable hard drives, are usually used within, and not outside, electronic devices such as digital cameras and mobile phones to provide extended memory.

True, both USB flash drives and memory cards use a flash memory, but these have different interfaces. A USB flash drive has a USB interface. Memory cards, on the other hand, have the user interface used in cellphones and cameras. These also need a card reader, while a USB flash drive does not.

How much data can be stored on a memory card?

The number of songs or images that can be stored on a memory card depends on the size of the media files, the capacity of the card, recording format, etc.

For cameras, storage capacity depends on the camera resolution; higher-resolution photos have bigger file size. Similarly, if you store music, it would depend on the bit rate of the song being stored.

A 2GB card, for 3.5-minute duration of each song, can store 500 songs or 1300 photos or 8 hours of video.

How secure are memory cards?

Many companies are offering lifetime warranty for their memory cards. However, unlike CDs/DVDs, memory cards are prone to virus attacks. Also, you handle CDs/DVDs carefully as these look sensitive because of the material used in their construction. On the other hand, after some time of usage, you tend to get a bit careless with memory cards and start using them in a rough manner, as these are convenient to hold and look sturdy.

compatible with the device in terms of format, speed and the capacity. So first check the memory slot in the device you own before buying the card. The memory card selected should fit in the slot of your device. The specification of the device usually states the minimum card requirement to take advantage of its full features. New cameras from

Sony have dual slots: Memory Stick Pro Duo and SDHC. That means normal SD cards will also go into Sony cameras.

Also check what capacity of card the device can take and whether it can accept a high-speed card. The kind of

data that is to be stored determines the size of the memory card.

Different kinds of phone users can buy the maximum capacity as listed below:

1. Casual phone users: Up to 2 GB
2. Multimedia phone users: 4-16 GB
3. Smart phone users: 16 GB or 32 GB

That does not mean these phones cannot accept lower capacity. They all are backward-compatible.

However, your camera or phone box must have SDHC logo in order to support 4 GB and above cards. Most of the Sony phones and cameras support everything from 2 GB to 16 GB.

For a high-resolution camera, you need to buy a high-capacity card. The high resolution of the camera means that the pictures will be taken at high resolution and will take a larger space to store. It's because of the limitation of space that you need a high-capacity card.

When recording, file size can't be more than 4 GB. For example, if you have an 8GB or 16GB card, and want to do the recording, after every 4 GB, you'll have to make a separate file. SanDisk has come up with a new card that can record 64 GB without breaking the files. These extended-capacity cards are supported by only a few cameras from Canon and Panasonic.

Next, look for transfer speed—the time it takes in saving the picture and making the camera ready to click another picture. A more demanding usage may require faster type of memory cards. For example, professional photographers need to click pictures faster, so the time lag between consecutive clicks should be minimal. So a high-resolution professional DSLR camera requires a memory card with faster transfer rate, while a slower card may be sufficient for an average-resolution consumer-grade camera.

If you need to click pictures too often, e.g., on a wedding occasion, look for a high-capacity card.

If your camera is up to 6 meg-



Kingston SDHC video cards